New Zealand Rogaining Association (Inc.)

Minutes of 2013 Annual General Meeting
25th February 2013

Date: Monday 25th February 2013, 7.30 pm
Venue: 6 Harrods Court, Christchurch

Present: Peter Squires, Bill Kennedy, Emma DeLacey, Trevor Merrifield, Tim Farrant, Grant Hunter
Apologies: Dave Laurie

Minutes of the 2012 AGM and matters arising
The minutes were adopted as a fair record of the meeting for the year ending February 2012. Noted that no progress has been made towards enacting a national rogaining series.

President's Annual Report
The President's report for 2012/213) highlighted (1) the importance of the annual Heights of Winter Rogaine as the premier event on the calendar, (2) the challenges we face in NZ in delivering a 24 hour championship event annually through limited organisational resources, (3) direct access to event organisers to public liability insurance for one-off events has reduced the role of NZRA in providing cover. This is seen as positive move for rogaining, though a lower reliance on this service may require NZRA to re-think aspects of its core role, (4) while short events (e.g. 3 to 6 hour) are flourishing in many regions, it continues to be challenging to muster local resources for 12-24 hour durations, (5) the need to attract more younger people, especially to leadership and organisational roles.

Financial report
NZRA incurred a paper loss of ca $1700 for the year, but this is rendered negligible by several late payments as at year-end. Major revenue sources were Heights of Winter and interest earned. NZ Champs in Otago were cost-neutral (a loss of $162). Navlight continues to be financially viable, though sponsorship of the School Champs in Taranaki uses up any paper credits. The financial report was adopted (ED/PS).

Election of Officers
Given that no new nominations were to hand, the meeting agreed to re-nominate all existing officers. The following were confirmed, subject to individual agreements.

President: Peter Squires
Secretary: Grant Hunter
Treasurer: Trevor Merrifield
Committee: Emma De Lacey, Tim Farrant, and Douglas Woods, Dave Laurie, Nick Collins (last three subject to agreement)

With no nominations exceeding places to be filled there was no voting.

Regional representatives:
(the following are re-nominated, subject to their agreement).

Auckland –Shaun Collins. Alastair McDowell to be invited also (– confirmed available)

Taranaki – Annie Sanderson
Bay of Plenty/Central NI – Mark Copeland
Taupo – Darren Ashmore
Wellington –Jamie Stewart
Marlborough – Alan Holdaway, Mondo Kopua
Central Otago – Ed Stevens
Otago – Bob Cunninghame. It was agreed that Matt Bixley be invited to act as an additional rep for Otago. (– confirmed available)

Noted that the role of regional rep can be low key, emphasis being placed on having a knowledgeable rogainer locally accessible for advice to newcomers etc. Reps are also likely to be active in local/regional rogaining.

International Rogaining Federation (IRF) Representatives: Nick Collins, with Emma DeLacey replacing Alan.

Alan Holdaway had indicated a preference to stand down from his role as IRF rep. Alan was thanked for his longstanding contributions to international rogaining, which had especially focused on technical aspects of the sport. (The Secretary to advise IRF of this change, and to thank Alan)

Agreed that Bill Kennedy will liaise with David Baldwin, technical subcommittee of the Australian RA as a way for NZ to have input to the IRF Technical Committee. Accessing the IRF technical group through the ARA will also help ensure Australia and NZ rogaining interests work towards speaking with one voice in the international arena.

Technical roles:

Webmaster and membership: Bill Kennedy
Facebook coordinator: Tim Farrant (new role)
Navlight: Jac Woudberg
Gear controller and Assets: Dave Laurie and Douglas Woods
NZ Champs liaison: Tim Farrant

Other business

NZ Champs

- No evidence of a venue or organising team in the North Island, though awaiting feedback from one or two lines of enquiry.
- Assuming that no opportunity for a NI event arises soon, there will be no 24 hour championship event in 2013.
- The meeting decided to float to membership (via Facebook and the Website) the notion that until a firm proposal emerges for an event in the NI, NZRA will revert to a two-yearly national 24 hour championship to be staged in the South Island. (We have options in both Otago and Marlborough but we are unwilling to exhaust these and the personnel by using them annually in succession.)
- The meeting left open the option for a 12 hour champs each second year, but views were divided and the meeting lacked clarity on the pros and cons of this approach.

Communication and electronic media tools

- Bill Kennedy reported he had migrated all content of the WRC2010 website to www.rogaine.org.nz, in preparation for the closing down of the WRC site. *(Bill has advised IRF that it will be shut down April 30th)*
- www.rogaine.org.nz is hosted on a goodwill basis thanks to NZRA member Greg Adams. This gives us some vulnerability, and it was noted we may need to shift to a fully commercial base in the future. The system is well backed up and migration could take place reasonably quickly and at short notice, though there is always a risk of downtime. (Web hosting by Web Drive at annual cost of ca $160.00 is favoured by the Webmaster).
- Acknowledged Chrys Horn's role in setting up an Association Facebook page but noted that the Assn. is not using it to its potential. Tim Farrant agreed to become more proactive on behalf of the Association. First up likely to be opening dialogue on the future format of the NZ Championship event.

Future role of the NZRA

While reviews show that NZRA is performing truly to its constitution and aims, the committee continues to be exercised with exactly how it can best serve rogaining in NZ. (To be addressed this through the year.)

Heights of Winter

- PAPO is struggling with organising this event since it is also hosting the NZ Orienteer Champs over Easter. NZRA has offered to help in a partnership arrangement. Dave Laurie to follow up with PAPO.
- Some interest in shifting the date to avoid the clash with the Australasian Rogaine Champs. Unresolved, as there is a range of pros and cons.

Meeting closed

Other events (Canterbury)

- Canterbury series: Tim Farrant is looking at dates (gaps in the calendar) for this three short event series. Likely to be spring.
- Office hours: Possibility for 7 hour Office Hours event, with dates late November/early December and /or March/April. Two venue options are in mind.

www.rogaine.org.nz

Annual Report 2012

With the World Championships of November 2010 behind us, we looked forward to a quieter year in 2012. NZOF was scheduled to run the National Championships, and NZRA was to organise the traditional Heights of Winter rogaine.

The HOW event is now recognised as the premier standard rogaine in the country, and this year was no exception with record numbers (424) competing in either the 12 hour or the 6 hour event. Always in search of more volunteers, we "co-opted" some new people to assist in the event planning, and this was a huge success! We now have a much larger team of talented and enthusiastic potential organisers. Interestingly, they all commented on how much they enjoyed being involved.

Unfortunately, the NZOF were not able to motivate any orienteering clubs to take on the National Championships, and we were obliged to either organise or abandon the event. Fortunately Bob Cunningham from Dunedin stepped up and got the ball rolling, and we had an excellent Championship event in November. It is understandable that the NZOF have difficulties in committing to a large-scale Rogaine; their first focus must be to meet the world standards required of the international orienteering community, and such rogaines are an added burden.

One of the founding principles of NZRA was the fostering of all rogaines, not just association events. The support we offered included Public Liability Insurance, which both the organisers and land-owners need. This support has engendered many privately run events over the last several years. More recently, insurance has been available on a per-event basis directly from the insurers, and the "blanket" coverage of NZRA has not been required.

This has been an excellent development. Many people are now organising innovative, novel, and attractive events which are great fun to participate in, and draw good support.

Now that these events can be totally independent of NZRA, the function of NZRA may need re-defining. For example, our focus might move towards fostering more events of a duration and standard which will train people for international competition, and towards developing organisational skills and enthusiasm in a broader base of potential event organisers. We also need to concentrate more on attracting young people into rogaining, and the School Championships which Nick Collins and friends organise in New Plymouth each year is an excellent model to follow.

The future of a National Championship, or indeed any annual 24-hour event, is not clear. These events are generally not well attended, and take a disproportionate amount of planning and landowner liaison to organise.

Some individuals and small teams have risen to the occasion, often many times, but this has placed a considerable burden on the same people and cannot be sustained. Without support from more and different people, in the North Island in particular, we face the prospect of having to cancel in some years or re-define our national championship event.

This may have serious repercussions for our top younger competitors wanting to attend World Championships. The New Zealand Championships have been recognised as a pre-qualifying event for entry into the world championships in the open grades. If we can't produce an event of suitable quality we will lose that recognition.

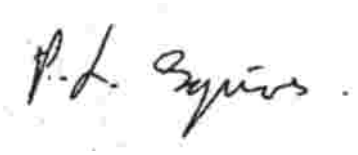
In addition, serious competitors would benefit greatly from a 24-hour experience before attempting to compete in any overseas event. Without this local experience, we must visit Australia to compete in either a State or National 24-hour event; a daunting prospect for those who may never have attempted 24 hours before.

We need more volunteers. Orienteering clubs have a built-in “volunteer” roster, whereby all members are expected to assist in 2 or 3 events per year. This “volunteering” does not usually preclude competing in the event, so it is not such a major burden.

Should we revert to a paid membership model, where members are expected to be involved in a certain amount of volunteer organisation each year?

I believe the time has come when we need to lead from the rear, rather than from the front.

I wish all you rogainers a happy and eventful rogaining year.



Peter Squires, President.